TWENTY OF THE WORLD'S FINEST PEN BRANDS HAVE NOW LANDED IN YOUR CITY.
editions.
PENS OF THE WORLD
Mantri Mall, Sampige Road, Malleswaram, Bangalore
Ph: 2266 7325 | info@editions.in | www.editions.in
A Odyssey India Limited Venture

DECCAN Chronicle
THE LARGEST CIRCULATED ENGLISH DAILY IN SOUTH INDIA
BENGALURU | WEDNESDAY 23 | NOVEMBER 2011

To Know About High Quality and Best* HAIR TRANSPLANTS
visit www.hairhospi.com
Dr. Madhu's
Advanced Hair Transplant Centre
Road 36, Jubilee Hills, Above Honda Cars Show Room, Hyderabad. +91 90004 11511 / 90004 11522

Weather

Max: 28.2°C **Min:** 16.2°C **RH:** 42%
Rainfall: Nil

Inside

CITY: Court orders probe into Somanna land deal ■ P3
INTERNATIONAL: Egypt rulers huddle as crisis looms ■ P10

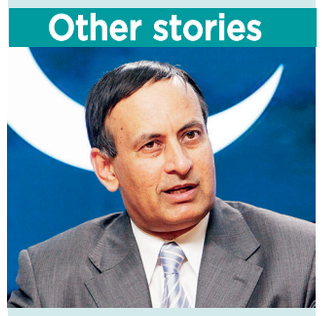
Windows

ASTROGUIDE:
Khara: Dakshinayana
Tithi: Kartika Krishna Trayodashi till 6.28 pm
Star: Chitta till 8.35 am then Svati till 29.53
Yoga: Saubhagya till 11. 54 pm
Rahukalam: 12 pm to 1.30 pm

PRAYERS (JAMIA MASJID)
Fajar: 5.35 am **Zohar:** 1.30 pm
Asar: 4.45 pm **Maghrib:** 5.55 pm
Isha: 8.00 pm

SUNSET Today **5.50 pm**
SUNRISE Tomorrow **6.22 am**
MOONRISE Today **4.06 am**
MOONSET Tomorrow **4.03 pm**

Other stories



HAQQANI RESIGNS OVER MEMOGATE

Islamabad: Pakistan's envoy to the United States Hussein Haqqani resigned over claims he wrote a memo to Washington asking for its help in reining in the country's powerful military. Mr Haqqani denied on Tuesday any role in writing or delivering the memo. The affair has highlighted the divide between Pakistan's weak civilian government and the military, as well as the role the US plays in the affairs of the country. He said, "I have resigned my services as ambassador and am happy to face an inquiry." — *AP*



Actress Archie Panjabi at the 39th International Emmy Awards in New York on Monday — *AP*

US REMOVES MAP WITH PoK IN PAK

Washington: The US state department has removed "inaccurate" maps of India and Pakistan from its website which did not reflect the correct boundary and geographical locations. "We have taken the map of India off the website. It did contain some inaccuracies which were associated with the boundaries of some geographic features," state department spokesperson Victoria Nuland said. "My understanding is that it wasn't drawn properly. We will put up the new map when we acquire one that we are confident is accurate," she said.

Counterpoint





INTERNATIONAL 10
Courteney wants to be a cougar in future



15 SPORT
Barath powers WI to strong total on first day

www.facebook.com/deccannews, www.twitter.com/deccannews, www.deccanchronicle.com
Vol. 4 No. 180 Established 1938 | 32 pages | ₹ 2.00



ACCIDENT OR ARSON? Fire engulfs one of the two AC coaches of the Howrah-Dehradun Express train at Giridih district of Jharkhand early on Tuesday morning. At least seven people, including an Australian woman, were killed and over a dozen suffered injuries. Police have not ruled out arson — *PTI*

Winter session: Heat on govt

DC CORRESPONDENTS
NEW DELHI, NOV. 22

The Winter Session of Parliament got off to a rocky start on Tuesday with the Lok Sabha adjourned for the day without transacting business as the Opposition refused to let it function, and the Rajya Sabha adjourned after obituary references.

As Prime Minister Manmohan Singh urged all parties to allow the session "to function smoothly", finance minister Pranab Mukherjee swung into action to defuse the crisis, inviting BJP president Nitin Gadkari home for lunch on Monday and meeting the Left leaders on Tuesday. Mr Gadkari however told Mr Mukherjee that if the government wanted Parliament to function smoothly, "it will have to take seriously issues raised by the Opposition, including price rise, corruption and the cash-for-vote scam".

The government also faces a hard time as the BJP is firm on boycotting home minister P. Chidambaram over his alleged role in the 2G scam and on bringing an adjournment motion on the black money issue.

The Left has threatened an adjournment motion on rising prices. The government proposed a discussion under Rule 193 on prices, and while the CPI looked inclined to accept this, the CPI(M) has rejected the proposal. The BJP is not averse to a discussion under Rule 193 (without voting) on prices. ■ Page 6

REDS REFUSE

■ Though the BJP and Left have come together, the Reds have refused to support a boycott of home minister P. Chidambaram for his alleged role in the 2G scam. Senior CPI leader Gurudas Dagupta said " We are not for boycott. We know who P. Chidambaram is. We will expose him."

Bellary: Minority card is key

BHASKAR HEGDE and SHIVAKUMAR MALAGI
DC I BENGALURU, NOV. 22

As the countdown begins for the battle for Bellary — campaigning for the November 30 bypoll ends on Monday — it no longer looks like the one horse race it was when elections were first announced and Valmiki strongman and Janardhan Reddy acolyte B. Sreeramulu seemed the runaway front-runner.

Unlike the 19 by-elections that have gone before, all the parties are throwing everything they have into Bellary.

The arrival of Janata Dal (S) MLA Zameer Ahmed Khan in Bellary, who despite being a stranger could work on Muslim votes for Sreeramulu, the independent's secret benefactor is out in the open.

The Congress party, its fortunes on the downslide since the 2008 assembly elections, is banking on the Muslims community's 40,000 votes to pull it through. Since Muslims of Karnataka do not vote as the community does in the heartland states to stop the BJP from coming to power, the BJP too is banking on the same Muslim voter base to boost its own Lingayat-SC-Kuruba base.

District Congress leader, Abdul Wahab however told *Deccan Chronicle:* "In the 2008 assembly ■ Turn to Page 5

More trouble for Yeddyurappa

■ The Lokayukta special court on Tuesday directed Lokayukta police to investigate into former CM B.S. Yeddyurappa's illegal denotification of 22 guntas of land, granted to housing minister V. Somanna.

DC EXPOSE: WIDOWED BY FATE, ROBBED BY OFFICIALS

AKANKSHA MEHROTRA
KANAKAPURA, NOV. 22

Widows from below poverty line (BPL) families, identified under the Indira Gandhi National Widow Scheme under the National Social Assistance Programme (NSAP) for a one-time payment of Rs 10,000 have been running from pillar to post while the bureaucrats and officials who administer such schemes look to make a fast buck, a *Deccan Chronicle* investigation has revealed.

A case in point is Chikkataiamma, a widow living in Uiyamballi in Kanakapura taluk of Ramanagara district. She promptly got a cheque, but was in for a shock when it bounced, not once, but twice. The then tahsildar, through his assistant, collected the bounced cheques from 30 families promising fresh ones, and soon after, was transferred. In Chikkataiamma's case, the unique serial number on the cheque even shows the status that the family received the money. ■ See Page 2

Telcos to PM: Give us our 3G money

PAWAN BALI I DC
NEW DELHI, NOV. 22

In a letter to Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, the CEOs of Bharti Airtel, Vodafone and Idea have asked the government to return the money they had paid for 3G spectrum with interest if they are not allowed to enter intra-circle roaming for these services.

"We submit that, in the event that 3G intra-circle roaming is now deemed impermissible, then it would be a clear breach of our contract and the pre-auction confirmation given by the government. In that eventuality, we request that our spectrum auction payments be refunded to us with interest, along with compensation for all the capital investments made by us," said the letter signed by Bharti Enterprises chief Sunil Bharti Mittal,

Aditya Birla group chief Kumarmangalam Birla and Vodafone Group plc CEO Vittorio Colao. Vodafone, Bharti Airtel and Idea Cellular had entered into a roaming agreement in July this year to serve their respective customers in circles in which they had failed to get 3G spectrum in last year's auction.

This would help operators offer 3G services to customers in circles where they cannot build their own 3G networks as they do not have licences. This agreement, however, has been termed illegal by the department of telecom and Trai.

RAHUL VOWS TO TRANSFORM UP IN 10 YEARS

AMITA VERMA I DC
LUCKNOW, NOV. 22

Congress MP Rahul Gandhi kicked off a mass contact programme in UP on Tuesday by saying that if the Congress came to power in Uttar Pradesh, the party would transform the state.

Mr Gandhi who began the tour from Barabanki on Tuesday told a gathering: "It is the Congress alone that can change the situation in UP and within 10 years the state would be a leader in all fields. We want UP to be like Haryana, Kerala and Andhra Pradesh."

Mr Gandhi further said that lack of industrialisation in Uttar Pradesh forced youth to migrate to Maharashtra and Karnataka in search of jobs.

BIG B, BETI B AND 'BAY-B'

BACHCHAN BYTES

- Addressing the media for the first time post the birth of Abhishek and Aishwarya Rai's daughter, Abhishek and Amitabh said that they are extremely elated over the fact that a girl has been born in their family.
- "We wanted a baby and by the grace of god a girl has been born and there cannot be a more happy moment for us all." Big B told mediapersons
- When asked about the baby Abhishek said, "She is doing extremely fine. She sleeps a lot and is very well behaved. She doesn't cry and lets us sleep."
- Amitabh also thanked his fans for finding the original photograph which mischief mongers circulated online as that of his newborn granddaughter.
- The morphed photograph supposedly of Aishwarya with her baby went viral on the Internet with some people taking it to be real.
- "T 567 — People asking now why am I talking about this. Its to show how brilliantly the team of my fans club, found out the original!" he tweeted.



Amitabh Bachchan and Aishwarya Rai-Bachchan exit the Seven Hills hospital in Mumbai — *SATEJ SHINDE*

